WAGENINGEN
UNIVERSITY & RESEARCH

Open Science Community Wageningen

# OSC-W Newsletter November 2026

## Hello Open Science Community,

In this issue, we have an upcoming lunch seminar on FAIR software practices, a WUR citizen science project protecting snow leopards in Nepal, an important update for anyone with repositories on git.wur.nl, and our new grant tracker on the OSC-W website. We're also pre-announcing Open Science Day 2027, and we'd love your input on it.

*P.S. As always, the newsletter looks much better if you click the "Online version" link at the top of this mail.*




## OSC-W Event: From scripting to sharing: FAIR software practices for researchers

**When**: Tuesday 8 December 2026, 12:30 – 13:30. Lunch provided
**Where**: Forum, room V0031/V0034 (ground floor behind the IT helpdesk)
**Registration**: See below

Do you write code for your research, or expect to? This lunch seminar, co-organised by the OSC-W, the WUR Open Science & Education programme and WUR Library, introduces the FAIR principles for making your software Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable.

The session is open to WUR researchers and PhD candidates at any career stage, including those who are new to the idea of FAIR software. You'll learn about:

- Where to find training, guides, communities and support, at WUR and beyond
- Practical habits such as version control, documentation, licensing, managing dependencies and making your code citable
- Common pitfalls that make research code hard to reuse or reproduce, and how to avoid them early on

The registration form also asks a few questions so we can tailor the session to you.

Register here →




## News: Protecting snow leopards in Nepal? There's an app for that

How do you protect snow leopards and the livelihoods of the herders who live alongside them? In the Nar-Phu valley in the far north of Nepal, WUR researchers Arun Pratihast and Christina Cappello have been working on an answer with local communities, combining citizen science, a mobile app and freely available satellite data.

The story covers how villagers collect the data, how it helps farmers get compensation quickly, and where the team plans to take it next. Well worth five minutes of your time.

Read the story →

## OSC-W Event: Open Science Day 2027

Following the success of this year's Open Science Day, we're happy to announce that it will be back in spring 2027!

The theme for next year's edition is **Open Science and Knowledge Security.**

We're starting to plan the programme now, and we'd love your input. Do you know someone who would make a great keynote speaker on this topic? Or are there questions you would like to see discussed in a panel? Let us know!

Stay tuned for the date and more details.

Send us your suggestions →

## Reminder: Check your repositories on git.wur.nl

On 30 October, WUR changed all public repositories on git.wur.nl to Internal. They are still visible to WUR colleagues, but no longer to anyone outside WUR, and public access is now only available on request.

From an open science perspective, this is a step backwards. Openly shared

code is a key part of transparent and reproducible research, and many of these repositories are linked from publications, data availability statements and documentation that people outside WUR rely on. Those links may now be broken for external readers.

So please check your repositories. If any of them should be public, for example because they accompany a publication, you can request this by creating a ticket on the WUR Support portal.

It's also a good moment to archive a release of your code in Zenodo or 4TU.ResearchData, so it has a DOI and stays available regardless of what happens to any one platform.

If this change affects your work, I'd like to hear about it. You can reach me at ben.excell@wur.nl.

## OSC-W News: Find Open Science funding with our new grant tracker

Looking for funding for your open science work? We've added a funding opportunities page to the OSC-W website, listing currently open grants, subsidies and other calls specifically for Open Science.

We update it regularly with calls from a range of sources, including WUR, NWO, Open Science NL and 4TU.

There are currently six open calls, and a few have deadlines coming up soon:

- 4TU FAIR Data Fund: 30 November 2026
- Open Science NL Mobility and Development Programme: 3 December 2026
- Open Science NL FAIR Research Outputs: 23 February 2027

If you know of a funding opportunity that isn't on the list yet, let us know through the form on the page.

See available grants →

## That's all for now

Thank you for reading this issue of the OSC-W newsletter.
I hope you found the content interesting and good starting points for discussion.

I would love to hear your feedback on the OSC-W newsletter and your desires for the OSC-W as a whole. If you would like to share your (anonymous) opinion there is a form here, or you can contact me directly at ben.excell@wur.nl.

Ben Excell
Your Open Science Community Manager

**Wageningen University & Research**

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